

Session 2: How to Read a Text Like the Hebrew Bible

Key Takeaways

- The Hebrew Bible, or the Old Testament, defined reality for Jesus.
- The story of the Hebrew Bible is fulfilled in Jesus and brings greater understanding to what Jesus did on Earth.

Exploring Jesus' Bible

The Hebrew Scriptures that Jesus and the apostles would have studied consisted of a three-part collection, called the TaNaK in later Jewish tradition. The arrangement of the books in the TaNaK differs in a few ways from the order of the same collection in modern Christian Bibles.

TaNaK	Christian Old Testament
Torah (The Law) Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy	Pentateuch Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy
Nevi'im (The Prophets) Former Prophets Joshua, Judges, Samuel, Kings Latter Prophets Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi	History Joshua, Judges, Ruth 1-2 Samuel, 1-2 Kings 1-2 Chronicles Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther
	Poetry Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Songs
Ketuvim (The Writings) Psalms, Job, Proverbs Ruth, Song of Songs, Ecclesiastes, Lamentations,	Prophets Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations Ezekiel, Daniel
TaNaK Compared with the Christian Old Testament. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Introduction to the Hebrew Bible (2019).	

TaNaK	Christian Old Testament
Esther [The <i>Megillot</i>] Daniel, Ezra-Nehemiah, Chronicles	Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi
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Reflection Question

Why do you think followers of Jesus should invest time and energy into reading an ancient text like the Hebrew Bible (Old Testament)?